Switching SEO agencies without losing rankings: checklist (32 items)

Tick items off on your own accounts before you send notice. Start with the Google accounts: once you give notice, the agency has no reason to hurry.

Google accounts

- [ ] 1. Google Search Console: you are a verified owner, not just a user.
- [ ] 2. Google Analytics 4: you have the Administrator role on both the account and the property.
- [ ] 3. Google Tag Manager: you have account-level administrator rights and publish rights in the container.
- [ ] 4. Google Business Profile: you are the primary owner.
- [ ] 5. Google Ads: the account holds your billing details and your administrator access. Once the contract ends, unlink it from the agency's manager account.
- [ ] 6. Google Merchant Center (if you run an online store): you are an administrator.
- [ ] 7. The accounts were created with a company address, not a private address of an agency employee.
- [ ] 8. You have a written list of everyone with access to each account (you will remove them when the contract ends).

Domain and website

- [ ] 9. The domain is registered to your company and you have the login to the registrar's panel.
- [ ] 10. You have access to the hosting and to the DNS settings.
- [ ] 11. You have an administrator account in the website system (e.g. WordPress), not just an editor account.
- [ ] 12. You have a current backup of the website and the database.
- [ ] 13. If the agency built the website, its code is in your repository or you have a copy of it.
- [ ] 14. 301 redirects from old URLs are documented and stay on the server.
- [ ] 15. The robots.txt and sitemap.xml files sit on your server and nobody changes them when the agency leaves.

Content

- [ ] 16. The contract transfers the economic copyrights to the texts, photos and graphics to you (check the fields of exploitation).
- [ ] 17. You have a list of the articles and subpages the agency prepared: URL and publication date.

- [ ] 18. You know which sites host the guest and sponsored articles and whether they stay up after the contract ends.
- [ ] 19. The texts, photos and graphics are on your server, not on the agency's.
- [ ] 20. You keep your own copy of the descriptions from your Google Business Profile and business directories.

Links

- [ ] 21. You have the full list of links acquired: linking page, target URL, date.
- [ ] 22. You know which links are permanent (articles, directories, partners) and which are rented from the agency's private network.
- [ ] 23. The contract does not provide for removing links after it ends.
- [ ] 24. You manually checked 10 random links from the list: they are still on the pages.
- [ ] 25. You have an export of links from Search Console (the "Links" report) dated the day before the cooperation ended.
- [ ] 26. You know whether the agency submitted a disavow file to Google, and you have a copy of it.

Data and reports

- [ ] 27. You have downloaded the monthly reports from the whole cooperation.
- [ ] 28. You have the list of target keywords with ranking history (an export from the agency's tool).
- [ ] 29. You have saved an export of Search Console data (16 months) and GA4 data.
- [ ] 30. You have the list of changes implemented and work planned.
- [ ] 31. You have documented the conversion setup in GA4 and Google Ads: which events count as inquiries.
- [ ] 32. After the contract ended, you removed the agency's access from all accounts and changed the passwords.

5 things to check in the contract

1. Notice period. How long it is and when it starts running: from the day the notice is delivered or from the end of the month. One day of delay can extend the contract by a whole period.

2. Automatic renewal. Whether a fixed-term contract renews on its own, and by what date you must give notice to prevent that.

3. Exit fees. Contractual penalties, an early termination fee, a clawback of the discount for a long commitment. Work out the cost before you decide.

4. Content rights. Whether the texts, photos and graphics pass to you and, if so, from when (often only after the last invoice is paid).

5. Links after the contract ends. Whether the links are yours or rented. Links from the agency's private network usually disappear with the contract, and with them part of your rankings.

Order of steps

1. Take over the accounts before you send notice.
2. Download the data and reports.
3. Send notice in the form the contract requires.
4. Watch the website during the notice period.
5. Close the access when the contract ends.
6. Monitor results for 8 weeks.

Free review after your previous agency (30 min, online): we will go through this list on your accounts. Tel. +48 518 815 055 · kontakt@ai-seo-company.pl · www.ai-seo-company.pl/en/switching-seo-agency

This is a practical list, not legal advice. Check the notice terms in your own contract (the guide concerns agreements under Polish law). AI SIGNALS COMPANY P.S.A., ul. Grzybowska 12/14 lok. B-3, 00-132 Warszawa.